

Nokia to launch 10 new Symbian phones in India

The Finnish phone maker plans to roll-out up to 10 new Symbian-based smartphones in India over the next 12 months. Dispelling concerns that Symbian handsets could be immediately phased out in the country, Viral Oza, director, Marketing, Nokia India, said that Symbian and Windows Phone 7 would co-exist until at least 2012. By September this year, it will be possible for even existing owners of these devices to download Symbian Anna (an update to the existing Symbian operating system).

Nokia disclosed plans to launch the N8, E7, C7 and C6-01 with the new Symbian Anna software update, which "...gives users a set of new icons, a faster Web browser, improved text input and enhanced maps."



GitHub releases Linguist library as open source

GitHub, a commercial project hosting service that handles files of numerous types, has released its Linguist library as open source. The library is designed to identify the programming language in a file, and is also used to detect which syntax highlighter to use for a file, to work out when to ignore binary and generated files, and to generate graph data for projects, by language. By open sourcing the library, GitHub hopes that users will be able to extend it with support for new languages. It will be able to then incorporate these languages back into the GitHub system.



Firefox 7 drops 'http://' URL prefix

After Google and Opera, the Firefox developers have also decided to not display 'http://' when showing URLs in the address bar. The modifications have just been made to Mozilla's most recent nightly releases of Firefox (version 7), which will become Firefox 7 later this year.

The change, aimed at making URLs more readable, will also see elements of a URL such as 'www' displayed in a lighter font colour. Only http:// URLs will be affected—like Chrome, Firefox will display https:// URLs in full.

Now, an open source wireless microphone

Breakfast has released the Verbalizer, an open source development board designed to interface with Google's Voice Search for the Desktop. Simply touching a certain part of the device will remotely trigger Voice Search from up to 10 metres away, providing an audio cue telling you to 'Speak now' to submit your search. The board allows anyone to modify the device, turning it into anything from



GNOME Foundation gets new executive director

The GNOME Foundation has appointed Karen Sandler as its new executive director. Sandler joins the Foundation from the Software Freedom Law Center (SFLC) where she has been general counsel, advising a wide range of free and open source software organisations such as the Free Software Foundation, the Apache Software Foundation, the X.Org Foundation, Software in the Public Interest and the Software Freedom Conservancy.

"I'm very excited that Karen is joining the GNOME Foundation as executive director," says Stormy Peters, former executive director who has recently joined the GNOME Board as a new director. "Karen brings a wealth of experience in free software projects and at non-profits as well as a passion for free software. That experience will be invaluable as GNOME continues to expand its reach with GNOME 3.0 and GNOME technologies."

Nokia claims the N9 to be the 'fastest image-capturing phone'

The Finnish manufacturing giant has claimed that the new Meego-powered Nokia N9 smartphone is the "fastest image-capturing phone on the market". Its new 8-megapixel imager is said to be faster than the likes of the iPhone 4, the Galaxy S II, and even the Canon S95.

"In order to take a photo, a series of events must occur: the camera is turned on, the viewfinder gets ready, you focus on the subject and the image is captured. On the Nokia N9, this all happens in 2.6 seconds—much faster than our competitors. The HTC HD7 does all this in 8.3 seconds, the Samsung I5500 Galaxy S takes 5.8 seconds and the Apple iPhone 4 does this in 3 seconds. We've made sure the camera experience is as smooth and as fast as possible," company sources explained.